

CORPORATE POLICY REVIEW REPORT

Customer Protection & Grievance Redressal Policy

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Activity Title: Corporate Policy Review – Customer Protection & Grievance Redressal

Organization Reviewed: Titan Company Limited

Policy Name: Titan Customer Service, Returns & Grievance Redressal Policy

1. INTRODUCTION

Titan Company Limited, a Tata Group enterprise, is one of India's leading consumer products companies, selling watches, jewellery (Tanishq, Mia, CaratLane, Zoya), eyewear (Titan EyePlus) and fragrances (Skins) through an extensive retail network as well as e-commerce platforms. Because Titan is not a bank, this review adapts the "Banking Customer Protection Policy" focus area — customer rights, grievance redressal, disclosure, protection against unauthorized transactions, and complaint escalation — to Titan's own customer protection framework as a large retail and e-commerce entity.

The policy examined here is Titan's Customer Service, Returns and Grievance Redressal framework, published across its brand websites (titan.co.in, titaneyeplus.com) and its "Titan World" complaint-handling channel. As a company that processes a very large volume of

retail and online transactions, Titan's approach to complaint handling, return/refund protection, and escalation directly parallels the customer-protection concerns that the Banking focus area is meant to illustrate — just within a retail/e-commerce, rather than banking, regulatory context.

The purpose of this review is to examine how Titan defines customer rights, discloses its terms clearly, protects customers against unauthorized or fraudulent transactions, and structures its grievance escalation ladder — and to assess this against India's consumer protection and e-commerce regulatory framework.

2. POLICY OVERVIEW

NAME AND NATURE OF THE POLICY

The policy under review is Titan's Customer Service and Grievance Redressal framework, comprising its published Returns/Refund and Terms & Conditions pages, brand-specific policies (e.g., Titan EyePlus's warranty and returns policy), and its "Titan World" complaint-handling process. In nature, it is an operational customer-protection policy rather than a single consolidated legal document, spread across customer-facing web pages and support channels.

SCOPE OF THE POLICY

The policy applies to all retail and online customers purchasing Titan Group products (watches, jewellery, eyewear) domestically in India and, with narrower protections, to international orders shipped to select countries. It covers order-related issues, product defects, warranty claims, and service-centre experience, and extends to guest as well as registered customers.

EMPLOYEES/STAKEHOLDERS COVERED

- Domestic retail and online customers across Titan's brands.
- International customers in countries Titan ships to (Australia, Singapore, UAE, UK, USA).
- Titan's customer support, service-centre and Customer Service Head function, responsible for resolving and escalating complaints.
- Titan World app and social-channel support teams (e.g., WhatsApp) handling first-level complaints.

KEY OBJECTIVES OF THE POLICY

- Ensure customers can raise complaints easily through multiple channels (toll-free number, email, app, social media).
- Provide clear, time-bound processes for returns, refunds and warranty claims.
- Protect customers against fraudulent or unauthorized use of their accounts and orders.
- Provide a defined escalation path when a first-level complaint is not resolved satisfactorily.

3. KEY PROVISIONS OF THE POLICY

CUSTOMER RIGHTS

Customers have the right to receive products matching what was ordered, to have defective products returned or exchanged, and to receive warranty service applicable to their purchase. For Titan EyePlus, customers who are uncomfortable with a progressive lens can specifically invoke a 30-day non-adaptation return right, and general product returns are permitted within 7 days of delivery, reflecting a defined, time-bound customer right rather than an open-ended goodwill gesture.

DISCLOSURE

Titan discloses key terms upfront on its returns and terms-and-conditions pages: the return window (7 days for defect reporting on domestic orders), condition requirements (unused, original packaging, with invoice), and important limitations — for example, that no warranty is provided on international shipments outside Titan's service-centre network (only a certificate of authenticity), and that discounted online purchases at Titan EyePlus are not eligible for the standard warranty. This kind of upfront disclosure of conditions and exclusions is directly comparable to a bank's obligation to disclose fees, terms and exclusions to customers before they transact.

PROTECTION AGAINST UNAUTHORIZED TRANSACTIONS

While Titan is not a bank and does not process third-party unauthorized fund transfers in the way this term is used for banking, its published policy addresses the retail equivalent:

protection against fraudulent use of a customer's account or website access. Titan's terms reserve the right to recover costs and pursue legal action against persons who use the website fraudulently, which functions as a deterrent and protective mechanism for the integrity of genuine customer transactions and accounts.

COMPLAINT ESCALATION

Titan operates a defined, multi-channel escalation ladder for "Titan World" complaints: customers first reach Titan's customer support team via the toll-free number (1800-266-0123), email, the Titan World mobile app, or social channels such as WhatsApp. If the issue remains unresolved, the customer can escalate it to the Customer Service Head of Titan Company Limited. Complaint categories are explicitly defined, including warranty-service issues, order cancellation or return disputes, warranty-extension-plan charges, and service-centre matters such as delays or staff conduct.

4. COMPLIANCE AND GOVERNANCE ANALYSIS

Titan's retail and e-commerce operations fall within the scope of India's Consumer Protection Act, 2019 and the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020. Under these Rules, every e-commerce entity is required to appoint a grievance officer and a resident nodal person of contact, to acknowledge consumer complaints within 48 hours, and to resolve them within one month of receipt; entities are also expected to display customer care and grievance officer contact details prominently and to make best efforts to join the National Consumer Helpline's convergence process.

Titan's multi-channel complaint intake (toll-free, email, app, social media) and defined escalation to a named Customer Service Head function align well with the spirit of these Rules, even though the specific identity and contact details of a designated "Grievance Officer" or "Nodal Officer" were not visible in the publicly available pages reviewed for this report. From a governance standpoint, routing unresolved matters to a senior, centrally accountable role (rather than leaving them at store level) mirrors good practice seen in regulated sectors such as banking, where escalation beyond the frontline to a nodal/grievance officer, and ultimately to an external ombudsman or consumer forum, is mandatory.

If a Titan customer's grievance is not resolved through the company's internal channels, the same statutory escalation avenues used across Indian consumer-facing sectors remain available: filing with the National Consumer Helpline, and ultimately approaching the District/State Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019.

5. POLICY EVALUATION

STRENGTHS

- Multiple, accessible complaint channels (toll-free number, email, app, WhatsApp) suited to a large retail customer base with varying digital comfort levels.
- Clearly defined complaint categories (warranty, service centre, returns) that help route issues efficiently.
- A named escalation point — the Customer Service Head — for unresolved complaints, avoiding complaints being stuck indefinitely at store level.
- Specific, product-tailored protections, such as the Titan EyePlus non-adaptation return window for progressive lenses.

EFFECTIVENESS AND PRACTICALITY

The policy is practical for a mass-market retail business: short, clear return windows (7 days) and simple conditions (unused, original packaging, invoice) are easy for both customers and store/service staff to apply consistently across a large retail network. The multi-channel intake similarly reflects the reality that customers of different ages and digital literacy levels need more than one way to complain.

GAPS AND LIMITATIONS

- No specific published timelines (e.g., acknowledgment within 48 hours, resolution within 30 days) were visible for Titan World complaints, unlike the explicit timelines mandated for e-commerce entities under the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020.
- A named Grievance Officer or Nodal Officer, with contact details, was not clearly identified in the publicly reviewed pages — a requirement increasingly expected of e-commerce entities under Indian law.
- International customers receive materially weaker protection (no warranty outside Titan's service-centre countries, limited returns), which could be a source of customer dissatisfaction for the global customer base.
- Protection against "unauthorized transactions" is framed mainly from the company's protective standpoint (cost recovery, legal action against fraudulent users) rather than clearly explaining what a customer should do if their own account or order is compromised by someone else.

COMPARISON WITH GOOD CORPORATE PRACTICE

Compared with regulated sectors such as banking — where RBI mandates specific turnaround times, a Banking Ombudsman scheme, and detailed unauthorized-transaction liability rules — Titan's retail-sector policy is understandably lighter-touch, but could still benefit from adopting comparable elements: published response timelines, a named grievance officer, and a clearer customer-facing process for reporting suspected unauthorized account activity.

6. BUSINESS RELEVANCE

For a company selling high-value products like jewellery and watches, trust in the post-purchase experience — returns, warranty honouring, and complaint resolution — is as important to the customer relationship as the initial sale. A clear, well-publicised grievance and returns framework reduces disputes, protects Titan's brand reputation, and reduces the risk of regulatory or reputational fallout from unresolved consumer complaints becoming public (for example, via social media or consumer forums).

Strong customer protection practices also support risk management: clear fraud-related terms protect Titan from exploitation of its return and warranty systems, while transparent disclosure of return/warranty conditions reduces the volume of disputed claims. As Titan increasingly blends physical retail with e-commerce, a dependable, multi-channel grievance system is central to sustaining customer confidence across both channels.

Ultimately, robust customer protection contributes to Titan's broader governance and ethical positioning as a Tata Group company — extending the same values of fairness and transparency seen in its employee code of conduct and privacy practices into its direct relationship with retail customers.

7. RECOMMENDATIONS

- Publish explicit complaint acknowledgment and resolution timelines (e.g., acknowledge within 48 hours, resolve within 30 days) in line with the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020.
- Clearly name and display a Grievance Officer/Nodal Officer with contact details on Titan's websites and app, as required for e-commerce entities.
- Publish a specific process for customers to report suspected unauthorized use of their account or fraudulent orders placed in their name, including how such disputes are investigated and resolved.
- Extend at least a baseline warranty or defect-return protection to international customers, rather than limiting them to a certificate of authenticity with no service-centre coverage.

- Publish periodic complaint-resolution metrics (volumes, average resolution time, escalation rates) to reinforce transparency and continuous improvement.

8. CONCLUSION

Titan Company Limited's customer protection and grievance redressal framework — though not a banking policy — demonstrates several of the same underlying principles the Banking Customer Protection focus area seeks to illustrate: defined customer rights, upfront disclosure of terms, protection against fraudulent misuse, and a structured escalation path for unresolved complaints. Its multi-channel complaint intake and named escalation to a Customer Service Head reflect a practical, customer-centric approach suited to a large retail and e-commerce business.

At the same time, this review shows room for improvement — particularly around published resolution timelines, a clearly named grievance/nodal officer, and stronger protection for international customers and for victims of account or order fraud. The exercise reinforces that customer protection, whether in banking or retail, rests on the same pillars of transparency, accessibility, and accountable escalation, and that these pillars must be made explicit and easy for customers to find in order to be genuinely effective.